

First-Time Buyer Checklist

The Offer to Closing Process

This checklist walks you through the key steps from making an offer to closing day. You do not have to do everything on your own. I am here to guide you through each step and answer your questions along the way.

PHASE 1: Making the Offer

- Review comparable properties to ensure the price is fair
- Get pre-approval from your lender (or verify current approval)
- Decide on your offer amount and contingencies
- Choose your financing terms (FHA, conventional, VA, etc.)
- Prepare earnest money deposit (typically 1-3% of purchase price)
- Select your closing date
- Submit offer through your agent

PHASE 2: Offer Accepted

- Deliver earnest money deposit to escrow
- Order home inspection (schedule within 7-10 days)
- Schedule appraisal (lender arranges this)
- Get title search started
- Notify your homeowners insurance company
- Request seller disclosures

PHASE 3: Due Diligence (Inspection & Appraisal)

- Attend the home inspection
- Review inspection report with your agent
- Decide what repairs to request (if any)
- Negotiate with seller on repair requests
- Monitor appraisal process with lender
- Verify appraisal value meets purchase price

PHASE 4: Final Steps to Closing

- Complete final loan approval
- Obtain final loan estimate from lender (3 days before closing)
- Review closing disclosure document
- Conduct final walk-through of the property
- Confirm closing costs and down payment amount
- Arrange funds for closing (cashier's check or wire transfer)
- Gather required ID and documents for closing meeting

Questions? Reach out to me anytime. I am here to make this process clear and stress-free.